

Richard D. Lyday

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Professional Summary

Innovative software engineer with deep expertise in Python, C#, C++, C, TypeScript, Unity3D, and .NET. A rapid learner of new languages and architectures, consistently delivering value across varied tech stacks and systems. Proven record of mastering unfamiliar technologies quickly — from Unity game engines to Azure cloud pipelines — and leading initiatives in automation, UX optimization, and complex data processing.

Technical Skills

Languages & Tools: Python, C#, C++, C, TypeScript, Unity3D, .NET, VB.NET, JavaScript, SQL, PLSQL, Bash, Node.js, PHP, Assembly (CISC/RISC), PowerShell

Platforms: Azure, Hadoop, AWS, GCP, Windows, Linux, Unix

Concepts: Agile/Scrum, ETL, CI/CD Pipelines (Azure DevOps, Linux), UX/UI Design, Embedded Systems, Big Data Analysis, DevOps Automation

Professional Experience

Software Engineer – Sinclair Television Group Inc.

Remote | Feb 2023 – Apr 2025

- Developed ETL processes using C#, Python, and PowerShell to support the Unified Ad Sales platform.
- Architected and optimized ETL and automation workflows supporting Sinclair's enterprise advertising data systems, improving throughput, accuracy, and reliability across multiple teams.
- Received "Outstanding" performance ratings (2023–2024) — the highest recognition within Sinclair and considered unattainable — for exceptional engineering excellence, reliability, and leadership in automation and data processing.
- Transitioned legacy AngularJS apps to Angular 18, handling story mapping and team process improvement.
- Led reverse engineering of legacy code, contributing to web platform modernization.
- Implemented and maintained CI/CD pipelines using Azure DevOps, PowerShell, and Python in Windows and Linux environments.
- Championed documentation and DevSecOps best practices, improving auditability and system resilience through automation and consistent code quality.

- Collaborated with stakeholders to enhance system transparency, reducing manual debugging cycles and accelerating release cadence through proactive communication and secure data handling.

Daravenrk LLC — Founder / Software Engineer

Independent Engineering & Automation Projects · Remote · 2021 – Present

- Architected and managed a local GitLab CE instance with Docker and GitLab Runner integration, configuring CI/CD pipelines and automated backups.
- Deployed Jellyfin, GitLab, and other services in isolated Docker networks with automated recovery and monitoring.
- Managed Ubuntu-based servers, reverse proxies, SSL/TLS setup, and secure remote exposure for local and remote environments.
- Implemented SSH-key rotation, encrypted backups, and role-based access controls to maintain compliance and security.
- Experimented with automated testing pipelines and containerized replication environments to improve deployment workflows.
- Implemented lightweight observability using cron, systemd, and container metrics.

Freelance Software Developer (C# & Unity3D Projects)

Remote | Intermittently 2014–2023

- Developed and published Unity3D games for Android, PC, and consoles using C# (e.g., Survive, Painted).
- Built a real-time drone video streaming and control system using Node.js and WebRTC.
- Simulated robotic flocking behaviors in Unity3D and created procedural-generation systems using custom data structures in C++.

Developer – Insight Global / Optum (UHG Subsidiary)

Remote | Apr 2021 – Nov 2022

- Monitored and diagnosed cloud-based systems handling sensitive PHI/PII data.
- Automated data processing workflows via Bash, Python, and Java in Azure environments.
- Contributed to secure Agile teams managing global health tech infrastructure.
- Developed and supported CI/CD pipelines across Azure and Linux-based systems for big data processing and monitoring tasks.
- Resolved performance bottlenecks in active analytics pipelines ingesting PHI/PII data, ensuring availability for dashboards.

- Deployed pipeline updates and configuration changes on behalf of multiple teams, reducing dependency friction.
- Developed Python/Bash automation to eliminate repetitive tasks, improving reliability and reducing manual workload.

Application Support Specialist – Panasonic Energy (Gigafactory)
Sparks, NV | May 2019 – Oct 2020

- Supported in-house manufacturing and quality systems, troubleshooting SQL and PLSQL queries for battery production.
- Automated reporting and analysis with Python, reducing manual effort by 30%.
- Developed automated database backup workflows, improving data recovery reliability during production cycles.
- Designed and executed scheduled SQL/PLSQL ETL jobs to purge stale MES datasets and archive telemetry data.
- Implemented data validation checks that reduced malformed machine telemetry events, improving analytics quality.

Associate Developer – Capital Insurance Group
Remote & Onsite | Dec 2017 – Feb 2019

- Built VB.NET and SQL-based systems; led deployments and provided cross-functional support.
- Diagnosed and resolved production issues across web and database layers.
- Optimized internal UI components against UX standards, reducing user friction and improving task efficiency.
- Expanded ambiguous user stories into detailed engineering tasks with clear acceptance criteria.
- Instrumented analytics to inform UX decisions and prioritize high-impact workflow improvements.

Education

University of Nevada, Reno
B.S. Computer Science & Engineering – Dec 2016

Select Projects

- Unity3D Game Dev: Built multiple games with advanced AI, procedural generation, and animated behaviors.
- Automated Database Backup & Recovery Jobs: Developed automated backup procedures and validation scripts to ensure recoverability of critical production and quality systems.

- Ad Sales ETL Normalization Platform: Designed and deployed an ETL platform using C#, Python, and PowerShell to normalize fragmented advertiser and publisher datasets across streaming properties.
- Ops Automation Toolkit for Pipeline Tasks: Developed Python and Bash automation utilities eliminating repetitive manual tasks, improving team throughput and reducing errors.
- User Story Expansion & Acceptance Criteria Design: Translated vague feature requests into robust user stories with detailed acceptance criteria.
- Drone Streaming: Enabled remote control and video feed via mobile/Node.js infrastructure.
- Robotic Flocking Simulation: Simulated emergent behaviors using Unity3D physics engine.
- Assembly Language Music Generator: Created 16-bit music playback on Arduino using MIPS.